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Damián Vergara

Contact Information

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Education

2023 Ph.D. in Economics, UC Berkeley
2016 M.A. in Economics, Universidad de Chile
2013 B.A. in Business and Economics, Universidad de Chile

Employment

2024- Assistant Professor, Department of Economics, University of Michigan
2023-2024 Postdoctoral Research Associate, Industrial Relations Section, Princeton University

Affiliations

2025- Faculty Research Fellow, NBER (Public Economics)
2023- Research Affiliate, IZA@LISER

Teaching

Graduate Public Economics (Fall 2024, Winter 2026, Fall 2026)
Undergraduate Public Economics (Winter 2025, Winter 2026, Fall 2026)

Refereed Publications

1. “Place-Based Redistribution” (with C. Gaubert, P. Kline, and D. Yagan), *American Economic Review* 115(10), 3415-3450, 2025.
2. “Optimal Tax Information” (with J. Slemrod), *International Tax and Public Finance*, Forthcoming.
3. “Workplace Litigiousness and Labor Market Outcomes: Evidence from a Workers’ Compensation Reform” (with M. Lauletta), *Journal of Law and Economics* 69(4), 933-956, 2025.
4. “Do Policies and Institutions Matter for Pre-Tax Income Inequality?”, *International Tax and Public Finance* 29(1), 20-52, 2022.
5. “Combining Discrimination Diagnostics to Identify Sources of Statistical Discrimination” (with P. Domínguez and N. Grau), *Economics Letters* 212, 110294, 2022.
6. “Using Small Businesses for Individual Tax Planning: Evidence from Special Tax Regimes in Chile” (with C. Agostini, E. Engel, and A. Repetto), *International Tax and Public Finance* 25(6), 1449-1489, 2018.

Working Papers

1. “A Sufficient Statistics Approach to Optimal Corporate Taxes” (with D. Swonder), *R&R Journal of Political Economy*.
2. “Minimum Wages and Optimal Redistribution: The Role of Firm Profits”.

3. “Minimum Wages and the Distribution of Firm Wage Premia” (with M. Bergolo, R. Ceni, and M. Fondo).
4. “Directed Search, Pay, and Non-Wage Amenities: Evidence from an Online Job Board” (with V. Escudero and H. Liepmann).
5. “An Observational Implementation of the Outcome Test with an Application to Ethnic Prejudice in Pretrial Detentions” (with N. Grau), *Conditionally Accepted, Journal of the European Economic Association*.
6. “Discrimination Against Immigrants in the Criminal Justice System: Evidence from Pretrial Detentions” (with P. Domínguez and N. Grau).

Selected Work in Progress

1. “Equality of Opportunity vs. Equality of Outcomes: A Theory of Optimal Predistribution” (with R. Chetty, H. Kleven, and D. Yagan).
2. “Optimal Labor Inspections” (with S. Correa and P. Muñoz).
3. “An Anatomy of Wage Spillovers: Evidence from an Occupation-Industry-Specific Wage Floor” (with J. Feinmann and R. Hsu Rocha).
4. “Gender Bias in Standardized Test Scores: Measurement and Implications for College Admissions” (with S. Arredondo, M. Grau, N. Grau, and T. Reyes)

Non-Refereed Publications

1. “A Simple Model of Corporate Tax Incidence” (with D. Swonder), *AEA Papers and Proceedings* 114, 352-357, 2024.
2. “Trends in US Spatial Inequality: Concentrating Affluence and a Democratization of Poverty” (with C. Gaubert, P. Kline, and D. Yagan), *AEA Papers and Proceedings*, 111, 520-525, 2021.

Seminar and Conference Presentations (Scheduled *)

- 2027 Columbia*
- 2026 Empirical Microeconomics Conference (ASU), UCSD, IIPF Annual Congress*, UW-Madison*
- 2025 Michigan, PUC Chile, IMD Days (Warsaw), NBER Economic Analysis of Business Taxation, Workshop on Labor Markets and Public Policy (Bocconi), CMU Tepper, NTA Annual Conference, UCL
- 2024 ASSA Annual Meetings, Junio Micro-Macro Labor Conference (Columbia), Princeton, APEX Workshop (ANU), Junior Applied Micro Conference (EIEF), Global Minimum Wages Conference (Princeton), Michigan, M-NEW Annual Workshop (PUC Chile), Universidad de Chile
- 2023 Bocconi, OECD (CFE and ELS/JAI), Yale, Princeton, Chicago Booth, Chicago Harris, Northwestern, Michigan, UCLA, LEAP Conference (UC Berkeley), IIPF Annual Congress, GRAPE-IMD Seminar, Brookings Economic Studies, Universidad de Chile
- 2022 Universidad Adolfo Ibáñez, Berkeley, Universidad de la Republica (Uruguay), OPFS Workshop for Graduate Students, O-Lab Workshop for Graduate Students (UC Berkeley), LMF Job Market Workshop
- 2021 UC Berkeley, LACEA Workshop on the Economics of Crime, RIDGE Workshop on Public Economics, NTA Annual Conference
- 2020 UC Berkeley, Universidad de Chile
- 2017 NTA Annual Conference
- 2016 SAET Conference, Universidad de Chile, SECHI Annual Meetings, LACEA-LAMES Annual Meetings

Awards, Honors, and Fellowships

2025 Fondo de Evaluación de Impacto, Grant, DIPRES, Gobierno de Chile
2022 O-Lab Initiative on Racial Equity in the Labor Market, Fellowship, UC Berkeley
2021-2022 Law, Economics, and Politics Center (LEAP), Fellowship, UC Berkeley
2021 Center of Equitable Growth (CEG), Fellowship, UC Berkeley
2021 Strandberg Fund for Gender Equity in Economics, Grant, UC Berkeley
2020 Burch Center, Fellowship, UC Berkeley
2019 Institute of International Studies (IIS), Grant, UC Berkeley
2017 Lindau Nobel Laureate Meetings in Economic Sciences (selected participant), Lindau, Germany
2016 Best Student of Class, M.A. in Economics, Universidad de Chile
2015 Chilean Engineers Association Award to the best undergraduate students
2014-2015 Scientific Chilean Council (CONICYT), Fellowship for Master Studies, Chile
2014 Top 1 % of Class, B.A. in Economics, Universidad de Chile

Professional Activities

Referee for: American Economic Journal: Economic Policy, American Economic Review, American Economic Review: Insights, Applied Economics, Applied Economic Letters, Econometrica, Economic Journal, ILR Review, Journal of Economic Behavior and Organization, Journal of Economic Inequality, Journal of Labor Economics, Journal of Money Credit and Banking, Journal of Political Economy, Journal of Public Economics, Journal of Regional Science, Journal of Urban Economics, Quarterly Journal of Economics, Review of Economics and Statistics, Scandinavian Journal of Economics, Structural Change and Economic Dynamics.

Co-organizer of: North-East Labor Symposium NELS (2024, Princeton), NBER Public Economics Spring Meeting (2026)

Scientific Committee for: National Tax Association Annual Conference (2025, 2026)

Grant Reviewer for: Swiss National Science Foundation (SNSF), Agencia Nacional de Investigación y Desarrollo de Chile (ANID)

Graduate Advising (Dissertation Committee, Initial Placement in Parenthesis)

Ana Paula Franco (2026, Minneapolis Fed Postdoc, University of Manchester AP), Luciana Galeano (2026, Revelio Labs), Thomas Lloyd (2026, EM Lyon Business School AP), Eva Wang (2026, Charles River Associates)

Other Teaching Experience

2024 Guest Lecturer, Economics Summer School (“Topics in Inequality and Optimal Taxation”), Department of Economics, Universidad de Chile

2023 Guest Lecturer, MIPP Summer School (“Topics in Inequality and Optimal Taxation”), Centro de Economía Aplicada (CEA), Department of Industrial Engineering, Universidad de Chile

2018-2022 Teaching Assistant, Department of Economics, UC Berkeley (Undergraduate: Intermediate Microeconomics; Graduate: Mathematical Tools for Economics x4)

2009-2015 Teaching Assistant, Department of Economics, Universidad de Chile (Undergraduate: Calculus I x2, Development Economics x2, Econometrics I x2, Econometrics II, Introduction to Economics,

Mathematical Methods for Economics, Microeconomics I x2, Microeconomics II x3; Graduate: Mathematical Methods, Macroeconomics I x2, Macroeconomics II x2, Microeconomics I)

Pre-Doctoral Research, Policy Papers, and Book Chapters

1. “Diagnóstico Distributivo de Ingreso y Patrimonio, y Análisis de la Propuesta de Reforma Tributaria en Materia de Renta y Riqueza” (in Spanish, with N. Bohme, I. Flores, P. Gutiérrez, R. Smith, and P. Valenzuela), Ministry of Finance Report, Chile, 2022.
2. “Cómo Diseñar Impuestos: Teoría Económica y Evidencia Empírica” (in Spanish), in *Impuestos Justos para el Chile que Viene*, edited by J. Atria and C. Otero, FCE, Chile, 2022.
3. “Natural Resources and Educational Attainment: Evidence from Chile” (with R. Álvarez), *Resources Policy*. 76, 102573, 2022.
4. “Ambiguity and Long-Run Cooperation in Strategic Games” (with M. Rojas), *Oxford Economic Papers* 73(3), 1077-1098, 2021.
5. “Análisis de la Implementación de las Nuevas Reglas de Financiamiento a la Política y Campañas Electorales” (in Spanish, with E. Engel, M. Jaraquemada, and N. Campos), Informe de Políticas Públicas, Espacio Público, 2018.
6. “Principios para una Reforma al Sistema de Pensiones (in Spanish, with E. Engel, E. Fajnzylber, P. Fernández, S. Gray, and A. Repetto), Informe de Políticas Públicas, Espacio Público, 2017.
7. “Sistema de Pensiones: Opiniones y Demandas Ciudadanas (in Spanish), Documento de Referencia, Espacio Público, 2017.

Other Professional and Research Experience

2022 Tax Policy Advisor, Ministry of Finance, Chile
2018-2020 Research Assistant, Department of Economics, UC Berkeley
2016-2017 Researcher, Espacio Público, Santiago, Chile
2012-2016 Research Assistant, Department of Economics, Universidad de Chile, Santiago, Chile
2012-2013 Research Assistant, Chilean Antitrust Agency, Santiago, Chile
2010-2011 Research Assistant, ECLAC, Economic Development Department, Santiago, Chile

Other

Languages: Spanish (native), English (fluent)
Citizenship: Chilean